

DAY 20: SAVE MONEY ON MAKEUP

Part of me wishes I were born with an affinity for all things makeup and hair. I watch beauty vloggers turn back the clock with ease and think, “I can totally do that!” In reality, I stand in front of the mirror and use foundation that ends up being the wrong color, or smear my already thick eyeliner.

“It’s gotta be the products,” I say to myself, “I just don’t have the right products.” Which of course convinces me to buy the most expensive brands out there hoping it will change the outcome. I’ll let you in on a little secret...it doesn’t.

However, it *does* mean I’ve tried all sorts of foundations, mascara, blush, lipstick, and eyeliner (in multiple brands) to get the look I want. I still wouldn’t call myself a makeup expert, but after years of practice and experimentation, I finally have a morning makeup routine that takes about five minutes from start to finish. It’s definitely not over the top, and I probably don’t even use most of the products properly, but it works for me in the stage of life I’m in right now. At this point, I just want to apply it and go!

While I’m certainly not opposed to using a pricier product, my search for the best has revealed you don’t have to spend a fortune to get the quality you need. If you’re looking for ways to cut down on beauty costs, and still create a natural, effortless look, these six ideas are a must try:

1. USE WHAT YOU HAVE (OR RETURN IT!)

Am I the only one who seems to forget I have unused makeup stuffed in a back drawer? Usually it’s from an impulse buy or a drugstore sale I couldn’t resist, but if I would only remember to check my own stash, I probably wouldn’t need to buy any new makeup for months!